

The Complete Financial Guide for Young Couples

person is certified as being disabled. Whether additional disability insurance is necessary is a matter of individual judgment.

Quite often it's a matter of financial priorities. With limited finances for insurance, the priorities are life and health insurance first, then disability. Why? Your probability of dying or major injury is much greater than being disabled. If you do elect to buy disability insurance, I would recommend a plan that will pay for two to three years. Very few people are ever disabled longer than that. And besides, that may be God's way to redirect our lives.

QUESTION 6. Is eating out as cheap as eating in?

We're a young working couple with no children. Our lifestyles are somewhat hectic because of our schedules and, therefore, we eat out a lot. We both think that it's probably as cheap for us to eat out as it is to buy food and prepare it at home.

ANSWER: Almost never is this true, unless a large percentage of the food you buy is prepared foods, like TV dinners and precooked meals.

It is true that preparing meals for just two people is relatively inefficient because so much of the packaging in grocery stores is proportioned for three to four people. However, the solution to that problem is to fix double portions and freeze half for later use.

Doing that will also cut your dinner preparation time by about half. If you can cook and freeze a couple of week's worth of meals, you won't feel so much like you're always eating the same things.

One danger with developing the "eating out" habit is that it is difficult to break when you have children later. And even if you can still afford the cost, it's a bad habit nutritionally, as a general rule.

QUESTION 7. Who should write checks?

I keep our checkbook balanced, but almost every month I find